Module 2 workbook

Your Identity

People wage wars over identity. Identity gives us meaning, and meaning gives us purpose. So who are you?

Key ideas

Labels are not an identity

"I'm a doctor, a millionaire, a traveller, a parent, a foodie, a sports fan." Millionaires want to be billionaires; people long to be parents, and parents struggle with parenting. Labels never seem to be enough.

Are we special?

Animals eat, drink, sleep, work, trade, pair up, raise and train their young, build homes, roam and fight. If that is all we do, have we achieved more than they have?

The four animal goals

People often move through them in order: possessions (a car, then a nicer car), pleasure, praise (followers and likes), then power. Each one runs out. There is more to us than this.

Your identity has five parts

In The 8th Habit, Stephen Covey looks beyond success. At the core is your spirit: what brings you to life and gives you purpose. Then your body, your mind (thoughts), your heart (character) and your emotions (ego). They all interact.

Align each part with your values

Take kindness: kind words with your tongue, thinking well of people in your mind, generosity in your heart, and being gentle with yourself emotionally.

A good life is not just rich or thin

If your identity is aligned with good values, you have lived a good life, even if you never got rich or lost the weight. Start with the body, and with the tongue, because that is where you have most control.

Reflect

Finish the sentence five times: "I am a..."

Which of these would still be true if you lost your job, your money or your health?

Which of the four goals pulls on you most: possessions, pleasure, praise or power? How does it show?

Take one of your core three values. How would it look in your body (tongue, eyes, hands), your mind, your heart and your emotions?

Homework: where is your struggle?

Write down what you struggle with, and tick which part of you it comes from. Then circle the one area you most want to work on.

What I struggle with	Body	Mind	Heart	Emotions
1.				
2.				
3.				
4.				
5.				

Which of my values would help most with this struggle?

Practise

Watch the Identity Meditation. Appreciate each part of you: your breath, your eyes, the muscles you move, your thoughts (without overthinking), a heart that beats over 3 billion times in a lifetime, and your emotions, whatever they are today.